

champion in 2019, Tekkz won consecutive ePremier League titles in 2024 and 2025 at City, establishing himself as one of the most prominent EA FC players in the current circuit.

At Leipzig, he replaced the 2024 EA FC World Cup winner, Anders Vejrgang, on the 2025-26 roster, with the latter leaving for Saudi Arabian heavyweight, Team Falcons.

"I decided to leave Manchester City and join RBLZ Gaming because I felt I needed a change. Leipzig clearly showed me their plan, and that was exciting. At this point in my career, it was the best step forward for me," Tekkz said.

"My main goal is still to win the FC Pro World Championship. It's been a good step forward recently, and I'm happy with my performance—but I know I can play much better. I need to close games more consistently when I'm leading. That will make the difference between finishing in the top 8 and winning the tournament."

SUBWAY SURFERS IN COMPETITIVE GAMING

Subway Surfers has been one of the most downloaded games in the history of mobile gaming. The first game on the Google Play Store to cross the one billion downloads threshold, Subway Surfers has its biggest market in India, with 38 million downloads in 2024, according to AppMagic.

Now, the famous game is looking to enter the competitive space by announcing a collaboration with the multiplayer game Brawl Stars. The new mode, called Showdown, will involve six players racing on signature railroad tracks in a Brawl Stars-themed map.

Along the way, players must find boosts to speed up while avoiding obstacles until they reach the finish line.

"A competitive game mode within Subway Surfers has been one of the most requested features from our community over the last 13 years," said Celia Zimmermann, Head of Player



Experience at SYBO.

"We're excited to bring this collaboration to life and incorporate elements from Brawl Stars' beloved multiplayer-style gameplay into Subway Surfers for the very first time."

The mode will be live until October 5. However, the collaboration may be just the first step for the multi-million dollar enterprise to expand into competitive esports.

Niantic took a similar approach with Pokémon GO when it released PvP trainer battles in late 2018. This eventually led to the first-ever Pokémon GO Championship Series three years later.

FREE FIRE MAX INDIA CUP 2025 IN LUCKNOW

The Free Fire MAX India Cup (FFMIC) 2025, the first official esports event for the game since its ban was lifted in 2022, will hold its grand finals at the Ekana International Indoor Stadium in Lucknow on September 28.

The event features a prize pool of around INR 1 crore, and the following teams have qualified for the event:

GodLike Esports, Jonty Gaming, Total Gaming, Aerobotz Esports, Genesis Esports, Nightmare Esports, Reckoning Esports, Gods Reign, Team iNSANE, Vasista Esports, NG Silver Eagle, Team Hind, Revenant XSpark, Autobotz Esports, Nonstop Pros, Team Tycoons, S8UL, Kar98 Army

Did you know? World No. 4 tennis player Jessica Pegula is a Call of Duty enthusiast and has appeared in promotional videos as a transformed version of Sophia, a fan-favourite operator in the game.



WHO AM I?

I am known as "India's Aim God" in the FPS esports scene and was undefeated in CS:GO throughout 2019. I transitioned to Valorant in December 2020 and am currently playing for Revenant XSpark.

The answer will be revealed in the next issue.



Answer to previous issue's quiz: Khush "Jokerr" Singh

BUSINESS OF ESPORTS

The International Football Association and esports giant KONAMI have extended their partnership to promote the development of football esports worldwide through FIFAE competitions in 2025 and 2026.



EASTER EGG 'ANR'

ANR, short for Added and Ready, is used in Pokémon Go for remote raiding: a player will say they are ANR to signify they have added you as a friend and are ready for their raid invite.